

SNIPPETS

Tata Tele to offer services on GSM

Tata Teleservices (TTSL) is all set to launch services on the GSM platform shortly. It is compelled to do so due to the lack of a spectrum roadmap for CDMA operators and the limited allocation of airwaves. TTSL, along with Reliance Communications, took the first step towards the GSM by applying for dual technology licences in late 2007. RCom has already commenced GSM services in India.

BSNL to invest Rs 150 billion in FY 2009-10

To upgrade its infrastructure and roll out new value-added services, BSNL is going to invest Rs 150 billion this fiscal. It aims to add 35 million telephone lines by the end of this fiscal across the country and commission fresh 3G network. BSNL will use the investment for mobile expansion and services like 3G, broadband, wireless broadband, IPTV, WiMAX and mobile commerce (m-commerce), amongst others.

Airtel to unlock 3G iPhone in India

Apple has authorised Bharti Airtel to sell its 3G iPhones through Airtel stores to any user, not necessarily only an Airtel subscriber. Vodafone in Australia, Orange in Austria and Movistar in Argentina are amongst the 40 global carriers authorised to unlock these handsets.

RCom to create joint venture with Kribhco

Reliance Communications has entered into a joint venture agreement with cooperative society Kribhco to form a new company called Kribhco Reliance Kisan. Kribhco will hold 60 per cent stake in the joint venture firm, while the balance 40 per cent will be held by Reliance ADAG.

DishTV partners with Atom

Atom Technologies, a provider of mobile/IVR payment solutions, has partnered with DishTV to offer phone/mobile payment solutions to over five million DishTV subscribers across India. So DishTV subscribers can now recharge their accounts instantly through the phone over the Atom platform using their credit cards/debit cards, anytime, anywhere.

Intel to phase out Centrino

Intel is planning to phase out some of its brands, including the Centrino for computers, to focus on fewer top names as the chipmaker expands into new markets such as mobile devices. The company would stop using Centrino to refer to personal computers beginning next year. Instead, it will use the brand to refer to Wi-Fi- and WiMAX-based wireless products.

monitoring for its international markets.

Intel, Nokia to create future mobile devices

Further uniting the Internet with mobile phones and computers, Intel Corporation and Nokia have announced a long-term relationship to develop a new class of Intel architecture-based mobile computing device and chipset architectures which will combine the performance of powerful computers with high-bandwidth mobile broadband communications and ubiquitous

Internet connectivity.

To realise this shared vision, both companies are expanding their long-standing relationship to define a new mobile platform beyond today's smartphones, notebooks and netbooks, enabling the development of a variety of hardware, software and mobile Internet services.

HP and Alcatel-Lucent to form global alliance

HP and Alcatel-Lucent will form a ten-year global alliance to help customers leverage the convergence of telecom-

munication and IT. Once the definitive agreement is executed, these will jointly market solutions and capabilities that enable end-to-end transformation for service providers and enterprises.

The duo plans to launch a global go-to-market programme to transform communication networks into converged, next-generation infrastructure. As a result of this transformation, service providers will be able to efficiently deliver new, revenue-generating services.

Intel to set up visual computing research centre

Intel is investing \$12 million to create a new research centre that will explore advanced graphics and visual computing technologies. The Intel Visual Computing Institute will be located at Saarland University in Germany. The investment, to be made over five years, represents Intel's largest European university collaboration.

Intel's visual computing vision is to realise computer applications that look real, act real and feel real. "The lab's innovations will help make future entertainment, productivity and the Internet experience more intuitive and immersive," said the company.

FutureTV initiative: call for proposals

In response to changing consumer lifestyles and media consumption, several leading industry companies, with the support of the Media Development Authority of Singapore (MDA), have partnered to form a FutureTV network to leverage on the capabilities of one another to shape a new generation of media experiences. Together with MDA, the network is jointly calling for proposals from Singapore media companies and start-ups to submit ideas, technologies and approaches. The partner network aims to go beyond the traditional TV screen in the living room to enable the consumption of rich visual media on multiple screens over the Internet, mobile devices and large-format out-of-home displays.

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